

CRM MCP Server — Setup Guide

Connecting Claude Desktop / Cursor to your live CRM via the read-only MCP bridge in `mcp-server/`.

What you're setting up

A small, separate Node.js program that lets an AI assistant (Claude Desktop or Cursor) read live data from your CRM — dashboard figures, deployments, pending hours, payments due, employees, and clients. It can only ever read (GET); it has no ability to create, edit, or delete anything, enforced in code, not just by convention.

There are 6 steps: create a dedicated login, configure the bridge, test it locally, register it with your AI tool, restart that tool, and verify it's working.

Step 1 — Create a dedicated login for the bridge

Do this first, on production, logged in as an existing Admin. Use a login made specifically for this bridge, never your own personal account — every API call the bridge makes is attributed to whichever login it uses, so a dedicated one keeps your audit log meaningful and lets you revoke the bridge's access later without locking yourself out.

- 1 Log in to the CRM as an Admin.
- 2 Go to **Team** in the sidebar (under Admin & Tools).
- 3 Click **Add / + New** to create a login.
- 4 Fill in a descriptive name (e.g. "MCP Bridge"), a dedicated email address (e.g. `mcp-bridge@yourcompany.com`), and set the role to **Admin**.
- 5 Submit. A one-time screen shows the email and a temporary password — **copy both right now**. It is never shown again; if you miss it, use "Reset password" on that same Team page to generate a new one.

Why Admin and not a narrower role? Every tool this bridge exposes is read-only, so the real tradeoff is scope (what it can see), not risk of it changing anything. Admin is the simplest way to make every tool work immediately with no further setup.

Step 2 — Configure the bridge

Open a terminal in the `mcp-server` folder and run:

```
cd "C:\Users\JARVIS\Desktop\Al Jazeera CRM\mcp-server"
copy .env.example .env
```

Open the new `.env` file in a text editor and fill in:

Variable	Value
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CRM_API_BASE	Leave as-is — already set to your production API.
CRM_SERVICE_EMAIL	The email from Step 1.
CRM_SERVICE_PASSWORD	The temporary password from Step 1.
CRM_SERVICE_TOKEN	Leave blank — filled in automatically at runtime.

Save the file. `.env` is already in `.gitignore` — it will never be committed.

Step 3 — Test it standalone (recommended)

From the same terminal:

```
npm start
```

It should sit with no output and not exit — that's correct, this is how an MCP server behaves before a real client connects to it. Press Ctrl+C to stop it. If it prints an error instead, re-check the values in `.env`.

Step 4 — Register it with your AI tool

Claude Desktop

Open (creating it if it doesn't exist yet):

Windows: `%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`

macOS: `~/Library/Application Support/Claude/claude_desktop_config.json`

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "aljazeera-crm": {
      "command": "node",
      "args": ["C:\\Users\\JARVIS\\Desktop\\Al Jazeera
CRM\\mcp-server\\src\\index.js"]
    }
  }
}
```

If the file already has other servers listed, add `"aljazeera-crm"` as one more entry inside the existing `mcpServers` object rather than replacing it.

Cursor

Settings → MCP (or a project's own `.cursor/mcp.json`) takes the exact same JSON shape shown above.

Step 5 — Restart your AI tool

Fully quit Claude Desktop or Cursor — closing the window is often not enough, use Quit / Exit from the menu or system tray — then reopen it. MCP servers are only loaded at startup.

Step 6 — Verify it's connected

- 1 Look for a tools/plugin icon in the chat input area listing **aljazeera-crm** with 7 tools available.
- 2 Ask it something real, e.g. *"What does our dashboard look like right now?"* or *"List our clients."*
- 3 If it answers with real numbers from your CRM, you're done.

If a tool call fails, the error message it returns already tells you what went wrong (e.g. "API Error (401): ..." means the credentials in `.env` are wrong; "no response received" means `CRM_API_BASE` is unreachable from this machine).

Afterward: keeping this account healthy

- Treat this login's password like any other Admin credential — rotate it periodically from the Team page's "Reset password" action, then update `.env` to match.
- To revoke the bridge entirely, deactivate or delete this one login from the Team page — nothing else in the CRM is affected.
- The bridge is read-only by design in code (see `mcp-server/src/api.js`). If you ever want it to also write data, that's a deliberate future change there — not something that can happen by accident.